



WSP – Geotechnical Testing and Interpretation

MN-01107

Phase 1 Determination

Acquisition may be put into effect

23 July 2026

1. Determination and statement of reasons

Notified acquisition	WSP Australia Pty Limited (WSP)’s proposed acquisition of substantially all of the assets and the business of Geotechnical Testing and Interpretation Pty Ltd (GTI) as a going concern (the Acquisition).
Determination	The Australian Competition and Consumer Commission has determined under section 51ABZE(1) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) that the Acquisition may be put into effect.
Parties to the Acquisition	The acquirer, WSP, is a subsidiary of the WSP group, a global engineering consulting services firm. As part of its service offering in Australia, WSP supplies a range of geotechnical testing and interpretation services (geotechnical testing services) to customers for onshore projects. Geotechnical testing services involve testing samples from various sources and environments and interpreting the test results to support geotechnical engineering analysis and related work. WSP operates five accredited geotechnical testing laboratories in Australia (located in Melbourne, Brisbane, Perth, Adelaide and Olympic Dam). The target, GTI, supplies a range of geotechnical testing services in Australia for both onshore and offshore projects, with a focus on providing offshore marine testing services. Offshore marine testing services are a specific type of geotechnical testing service, where samples from the offshore/marine environment must be collected by specialised vessels and tested using equipment with specific modifications. GTI operates one geotechnical testing laboratory in Australia (located in Perth).
Overlap and relationship between the parties	WSP and GTI (together, the Parties) overlap in the supply of geotechnical testing services in Australia for onshore projects. The parties also have a vertical relationship, as GTI supplies offshore marine testing services to WSP.
Reasons for determination	When making a determination in Phase 1, the Australian Competition and Consumer Commission (ACCC) undertakes a competition assessment and considers whether it is appropriate for an acquisition to be approved or subject to further assessment in Phase 2 in accordance with section 51ABZJ of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) (the Act). In doing so, the ACCC must have regard to the object of the Act and all relevant matters, including the interests of consumers. For more information about the ACCC’s approach to considering notified acquisitions, see the ACCC’s merger assessment guidelines and interim merger process guidelines. In conducting its competition assessment, the ACCC has considered the information and documents that were submitted with the notification form and information from third parties. The ACCC has determined that the Acquisition may be put into effect as it considers that the Acquisition is unlikely to have the

	effect of substantially lessening competition in any market. In reaching its decision, and based on the material before it, the ACCC makes the following findings: • The merged entity would continue to face competition from multiple alternative suppliers of geotechnical testing services post-Acquisition. • The merged firm would be unlikely to have an ability and incentive to foreclose rivals' access to offshore marine testing services, given there are alternative suppliers of these services.
Applications for review	A notifying party, or other person who has been allowed to do so by the Australian Competition Tribunal, may apply for review if they are dissatisfied with the determination. Pursuant to section 100C of the Act, applications for review of the determination are to be made to the Australian Competition Tribunal before the end of 14 calendar days after this statement of reasons was included on the ACCC's Acquisitions Register. To confirm whether there has been any application for review, please contact the Australian Competition Tribunal.

**Determination made by Commissioner Williams pursuant to a delegation under section 25(1)
of the Act**